

From Initiatives to Infrastructure

What Arterial could build — and offer the art world — the day
it owns the platform beneath everything it already does.

A Polymash proposal

For discussion with Scott

June 2026

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

Imagine What Arterial Could Offer

White-label galleries

Spin up a branded online gallery for a partner in an afternoon — their look, their artists, our infrastructure underneath.

Customized online exhibitions

Every show its own design, parameters, and story — sliders, dimensions on or off, animated storytelling. Not one rigid template.

Partnerships as living collaborations

Turn relationships into running, visible exhibitions and shared programs — not one-off favors that disappear after the event.

Infrastructure for the smaller players

Give small galleries and artists who have no online infrastructure a way to submit, exhibit, and be discovered — through us.

A suite of **services** Arterial could offer — not another one-off project. Today, we can build none of them.

ONE THING STANDS IN THE WAY

We Rent And Stitch — We Don't Own

Everything Arterial runs on today is **rented and stitched together** — a sprawl of tools that don't talk to each other. Some of it can stay (WordPress and the content tools aren't going anywhere). But none of it is an owned home for the thing that matters most:

Artwork Archive

WordPress + plugins

Ghost + Elfsight

Airtable

ActiveCampaign

Paperform

paper forms

InstaPage

Thinkific

StoryChief

Convertbox

n8n scripts

one-off websites

Arterial's artists, artworks, and exhibitions have no platform of their own. Build that one layer — and everything on the last slide is on the table.

WHAT EVERYTHING ALREADY RUNS ON

Arterial's Real Asset: Its Artists & Artworks

Almost everything Arterial makes draws on the same thing: our **collection of artists and artworks**. Built over years of open calls, grants, and exhibitions.

10,000+

artworks

1,000s

of artists



THE SHARED CORE

Artists

Artwork

Submissions

Exhibitions

Partnerships

Not Real Art, Artsville, the NRA Grant, the exhibition series, Sugar Press — all pull from this. **Own it, and everything downstream is ours to shape.**

THE MOVE

Own The Core, And Two Things Happen

ONE OPERATING SYSTEM

Every initiative plugs into one owned substrate

Art House pulls artists from it. Artsville shows exhibitions from it. The Grant feeds it. The *next* initiative launches **on** it — instead of being rebuilt from scratch in yet another tool.

ONE MATURE INSTITUTION

The portfolio finally reads as a real organization

An owned platform is what turns a constellation of projects into a capable institution with its own infrastructure — one place the whole portfolio finally connects.

The art world's own value is consolidating around exactly this — owned platforms plus proprietary data. In 2025, Beowolff Capital bought Artnet and merged it with Artsy into a single data-and-AI ecosystem. Platform + data *is* the asset.

ONLY POSSIBLE WHEN WE OWN IT

A Platform, Not A Feature

Configurable exhibitions

Dimensions on or off, sliders, highlight widgets, animated storytelling — per show.

QR: wall to phone

Scan a physical label, get the full artist record, more works, and an inquiry path.

Per-exhibition radio

AI-produced audio & podcasts about a show — on our own engine.

Visual, vector-driven discovery

The platform understands how works relate — by color, style, region, artist — to surface what's adjacent.

Partner analytics

Engagement, dwell, geography — insight a small gallery has never had.

AI curator

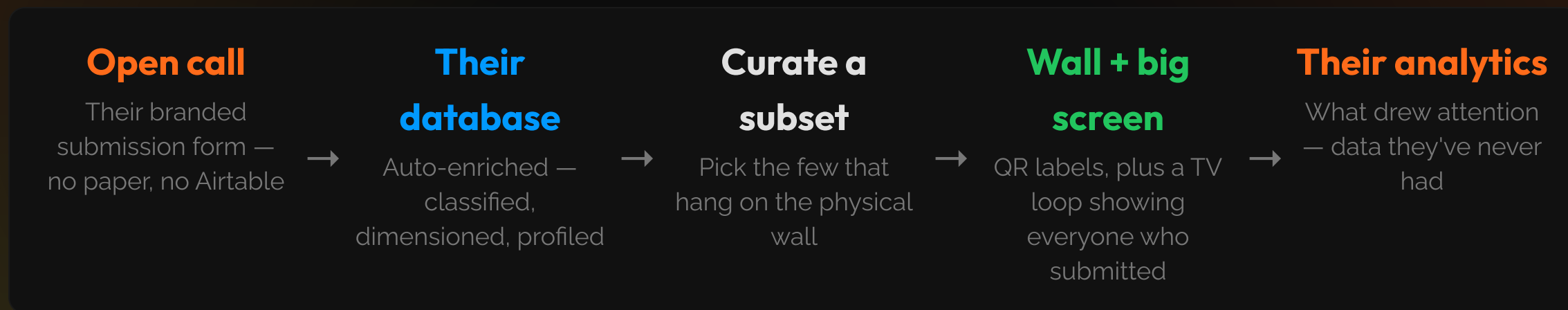
"A show in greens, under 36 inches" — propose themed exhibitions from the archive.

One owned substrate — many expressions. None of these are possible while the art lives in someone else's rented software.

MADE CONCRETE

A Partner Gallery, Powered By Us

A small gallery with no online infrastructure runs an entire exhibition on our platform — white-labeled as theirs:



A 12-piece room **feels like** a 200-artist exhibition. The white-label service, the QR bridge, the analytics — the same platform, configured for them.

FROM DISCOVERY TO INCOME

The Loop Only We Can Close

Owning the substrate lets discovery flow all the way to **sustainable revenue** — and it amplifies artists rather than walling anyone out.



↳ Revenue funds artists *and* Arterial — which draws in more artists. A flywheel, not a toll booth.

You can't route discovery into print commerce through a gallery plugin and a paper form. The owned platform is what connects the two ends.

THE ASSET IS ALREADY IN THE BUILDING

Thousands Of Artists, Waiting To Be Reached

WHAT WE ALREADY HAVE

An audience of artists built over years of open calls and grants. They opted in. They submitted. They care about what Arterial does. **They're not gone — they're un-reached.**

WHAT THE PLATFORM DOES

Makes staying in touch **systematic**: self-service artist profiles that keep themselves current, automated re-engagement, and discovery that pulls artists back into Arterial's orbit on their own.

The cheapest growth Arterial has isn't new reach — it's re-activating the relationships already sitting in our own collection.

WHEN WE CHOOSE, NOT BEFORE

Partnerships Become A Switch We Control

Because the platform is **multi-tenant by design**, a partner instance is a *configuration* — not a rebuild. The infrastructure flexes to whoever Arterial chooses to work with, whenever it makes sense.

No commitment to "become a software vendor." Just the option to extend what we run — to a CodaWorks collaboration, a public-art project, a regional gallery — at the press of a switch.

ONE ENGINE, MANY TENANTS

Arterial & Not Real Art

Artsville USA

CodaWorks · public art

+ any partner, when we choose

WHY THIS IS REAL

Proven Pieces, Built To Be Owned

NOT STARTING FROM ZERO

The enrichment pipeline, the 10,000-artwork dataset, and the vector engine that understands how artworks relate **already run in production**.

This is assembling proven pieces — not a moonshot.

BUILT TO BE OWNED, NOT BABYSAT

Industry best practices, fully documented, handoff-able. **No key-person dependency** — Arterial owns and operates it. The platform is an asset on the books, not a person on call.

WHAT WE'RE ASKING

Agree On The Principle. Fund The First Step.

THE PRINCIPLE

An owned platform, built on the artists and artworks Arterial already has, is worth pursuing — and the first move is to replace rented Artwork Archive with our own production-ready system.

THE FIRST PHASE — A FUNDED POLYMASH SCOPING & FOUNDATION ENGAGEMENT

Migration plan & roadmap

Design docs and a roadmap to replace Artwork Archive with an owned system — porting our submissions work into one consolidated database.

A working proof of concept

An embeddable gallery running on our own infrastructure (Next.js + Supabase) — the first real replacement piece, live on our data.

A promotable site

A website explaining what the platform is, what it does, and who benefits — inviting inquiries, so Scott has something real to promote now.

The question isn't whether to build it.

It's whether Arterial keeps renting its future — or finally owns the thing every one of its initiatives already depends on.

POLYMASH

Sources & References

A vision deck — these back the few external claims

Art-market value is consolidating around owned platforms + proprietary data. In 2025 Beowolff Capital acquired Artnet (~\$73.7M) and merged it with Artsy into one data-and-AI ecosystem. — Artnet News; ARTnews.

The rented gallery layer offers one rigid exhibition format — the limitation this platform removes. — Artwork Archive public exhibition/feature documentation; Arterial team production use.

Vector-embedding visual similarity is the established technique behind the platform's "how artworks relate" discovery — the same approach Polymash already runs in production in the Intersect curator.

Full URLs, quotes, and retrieval dates: `research/sources.md` in the idea folder.